

ally any kind that can be used by the HTML file to fetch the information from them. The XML code should always begin with `<?xml version=1.0?>` tag, which helps the HTML file to recognise the XML file.

The JavaScript code is customisable depending upon the parameters of XML tags. We have used five tags in the XML database: `<n>` for number, `<t>` for train name, `<f>` for frequency, `<a>` for arrival and `<d>` for departure details. Hence the `TrainNumber+=`

`recordSet("n")` line in the code can be changed accordingly. Currently, it is set to 'n', i.e., it fetches database records having '`<n></n>`' tags till end of the file.

Normally, when the time-table is on the screen, you can directly press Ctrl+F to find particular information. But in this program, the information is locked in JavaScript and therefore even if you press Ctrl+F keys followed by 'Find Next' button, you will not get highlighting of the

item during the search. You have to enter the keyword or train number in the space provided and click 'Search' button to find the required information. The program displays a particular search result in detail. For example, when you enter '2839' as the train number, detailed information about this train will appear as shown in Screenshot 3.

EFY note. All the relevant source files of this project have been included in this month's EFY-CD.

EXECUTIVE DASHBOARD IN VISUAL BASIC



■ VEERANNA V.K. AND JANAKIDEVI S.J.

Digital dashboards are common in cars. These display a multitude of information to keep the car running, such as the speed of the car, fuel level, and battery-low and hot-engine warning.

How about an executive dashboard that displays their company-specific information on a desktop/laptop in the form of graphics? Information like current sales, revenue income, quarterly expenses, and strength and daily reports of the employees could be updated regularly and seen on the dashboard.

Just like car dashboards, executive dashboards may vary in appearance, depending on the needs of the executives for which they are designed. The executive dashboards may provide:

1. Access through a Web browser
2. Graphs to present

maximum details

3. More details upon clicking the relevant graph or part of graph

4. Automatic updation with the latest available data

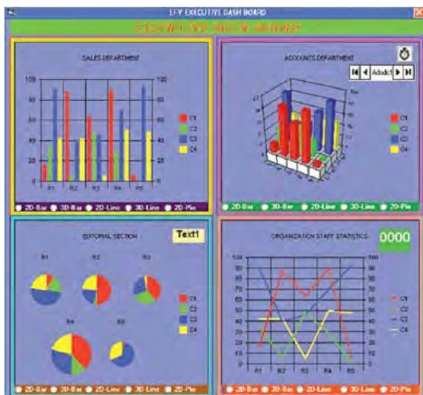
5. Print, save and sharing facility for the information displayed on the dashboard

Generally, dashboards are designed

using MS Excel or MS Word. Here we describe a simple executive dashboard designed in Visual Basic 6 (VB6) without using Excel or Word. The program is tested in VB6 and Windows XP environments.

We've used the MS Chart ActiveX control available in Visual Basic that has many of the features of graphs

available in Excel. We selected four arbitrary graphs to display the information about an organisation (EFY) as shown in Screenshot 1. Below each chart is a set of option buttons to view the information in various forms of graphical displays (such as bar graphs, pie charts and line graphs) in two and three dimensions. Save, print and Web connection functions can be implemented. The information appears on the executive dashboard as shown in Screenshot 2. Note that the scale and unit are not mentioned in these graphs. The



Screenshot 1: Four arbitrary graphs to display the information